

TYK2/PsO: Next-Generation TYK2 Inhibitors in Psoriasis — AAD 2026



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Summary

Two Phase 3 programs presented at AAD 2026 establish the second wave of oral allosteric TYK2 inhibitors as a credible high-efficacy tier in moderate-to-severe plaque psoriasis, with both envudeucitinib (Alumis) and zasocitinib (Takeda) clearing bar against placebo and apremilast across replicate trials. The efficacies of envudeucitinib and zasocitinib are similar and comparable to J&J's IL-23R oral peptide, which was recently approved as Icotyde..

Why it Matters: Phase 3 data of envudeucitinib and zasocitinib intensify oral psoriasis competition and challenge Icotyde's positioning. The high efficacy validated that allosteric TYK2 inhibition could match IL-23 blockade for psoriasis. Data from Takeda's on-going phase 2 studies of zasocitinib for CD and UC and from BMS's phase 3 for SLE will be inflection points for the value of TYK2 class.

Key Highlights

Envudeucitinib (ESK-001) — ONWARD1 and ONWARD2 (Alumis)

- Envudeucitinib 40 mg BID met both co-primary endpoints (PASI 75 and sPGA-0/1 at Week 16) in two replicate trials enrolling about 1,800 patients total.
- PASI 75 rates at Week 16 were 76.5% and 70.4% in ONWARD1 and ONWARD2 respectively, with PASI 90 deepening to 68% and 62% by Week 24 — and PASI 100 reaching approximately 40% in both trials with no evidence of plateau at 24 weeks.
- The absence of a plateau is a key talking point for Alumis, suggesting continued benefit with longer treatment.
- Early onset was notable, with meaningful PASI 90 separations from placebo visible at Week 4.
- Safety was generally clean: no deaths, no MACE, no cytopenia signals, and no TB reactivation (including 39 patients with latent or treated TB enrolled).
- Headaches at 10.3% and acne at 6.0% were the most notable TEAEs.

Zasocitinib — LATITUDE-PsO-3001 and 3002 (Takeda)

- Zasocitinib QD met co-primary endpoints in both trials (N=693 and N=1,108).

- sPGA-0/1 of 71% and 69% and PASI 75 of 76% and 71% at Week 16 — numerically similar to envudeucitinib. Deep skin clearance (PASI 100) reached 33–42% (3001) and 25–32% (3002) by Weeks 16 and 24, with sPGA-0 of 40–49% (3001) and 34–41% (3002).
- LATITUDE-PsO-3002 included a randomized withdrawal arm: >90% of patients continuing zasocitinib at Week 40 maintained sPGA-0/1, PASI 75, and PASI 90 through Week 60.
- Takeda's forecast of the peak revenue potential of zasocitinib for PsO and PsA is \$3-6 billion.

Click the title to see cross-trial comparison charts in details. With comparable efficacy and safety profile, zasocitinib has the advantage of daily dosing without fasting restrictions. Takeda plans to file the psoriasis data in FY2026. I estimate the approval date will be around mid-2027.

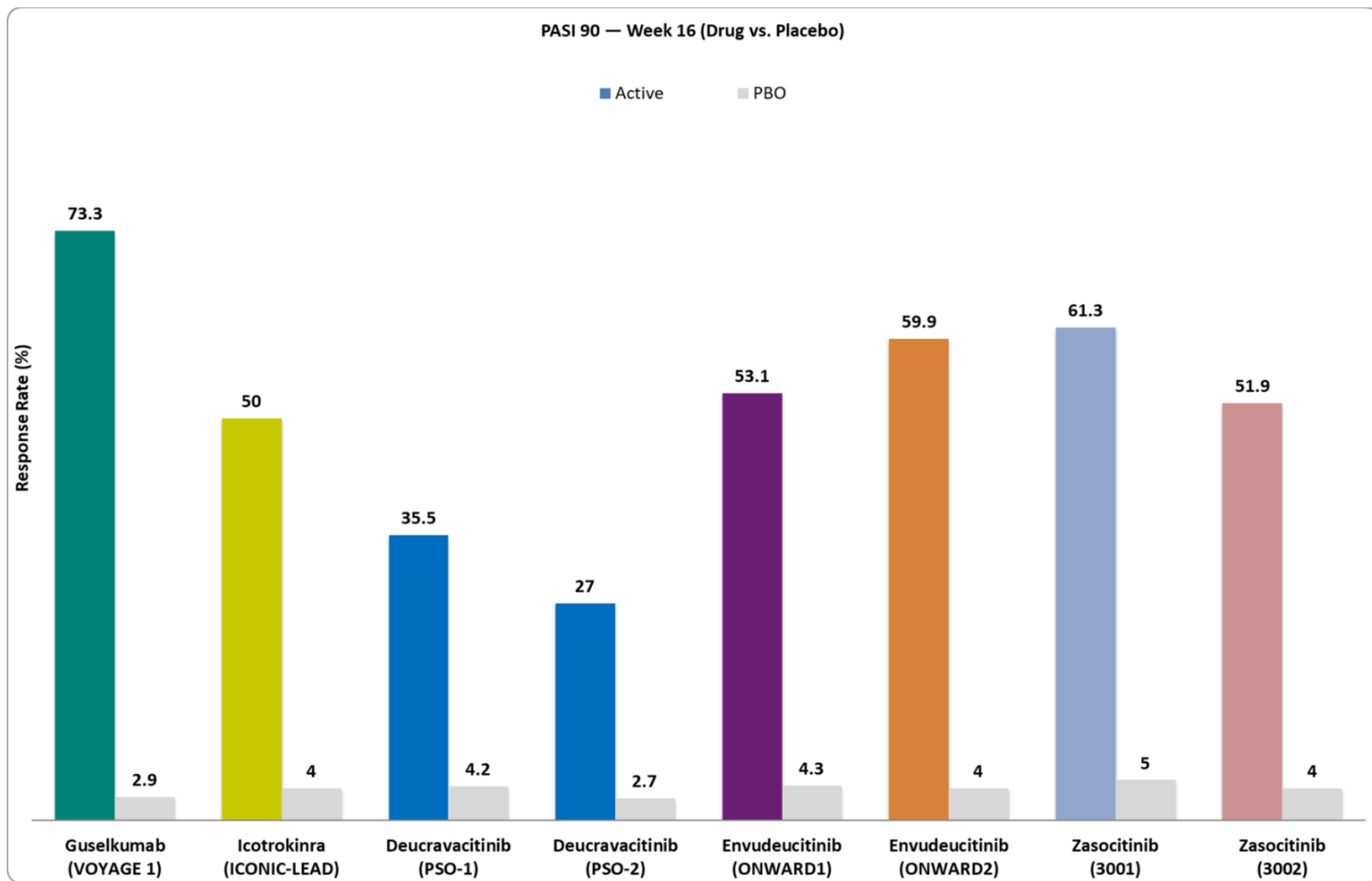


Details

See study designs and detailed results in **Sources** below.

Cross-trial comparison chart generated by Claude

PASI 90 at Week 16



PASI 90 at Week 24

PASI 90 — Week 24
(placebo crossed over at Wk 16)

